the years, the Mizrahim became the majority among the religious junior officers in the army: not so Orthodox as to shy away from military service, but enough to introduce a distinct and growing tendency in an army which, before that, had been essentially nonreligious.

Wednesday, May 3

Let me return to the present political situation: a crisis that was in the making for some time has erupted between the Likud and Ben-Gvir's Jewish Power. The evil clown complains about not being invited to meetings of the security cabinet, the weak reaction to the shooting of rockets from the Gaza Strip, the disregard of measures he had advocated against terrorists, etc.; in reprisal, his party has abstained from participating in Knesset voting. Jewish Power will open new headquarters in Sderot, one of the towns that suffers most from sporadic attacks from Gaza. A Likud spokesperson told Ben-Gvir that if he further abstains from participating in Knesset votes, he can leave the coalition, to which he answered: "You should dismiss me." That would be the end of the coalition. In short, Netanyahu has to face threats from the Orthodox party and from Ben-Gvir's. Is the end approaching?

Over the last few weeks, several main figures of the Israeli cultural scene have died: the poet Meir Wieseltier, the novelist Meir Shalev, the popular composer and writer Yonatan Gefen. They were all politically engaged, on the left, or even the extreme left. They follow a number of other writers, among them Amos Oz, who were trailblazers on the cultural left. Only A. B. Yehoshua was often undecided, yet never on the right. Since the crazy days of the Six-Day War, when a series of Israeli writers temporarily became advocates of seizing the whole land of Israel, the Israeli cultural scene has been on the left. The only main figures remaining of that group of writers are David Grossman and Etgar Keret. I am sure that there